

AWS Student Community Day Panipat 2026

Ideathon & Buildathon — Official Rules & Participant Guidelines

IDEATHON

**Solo / Team (max 4) •
Own problem
statement**

BUILDATHON

**Solo / Team (max 4) •
Organizer-provided**

TOTAL PRIZE POOL

₹30,000

1. Eligibility

- Open to college and university students.
- Participants must carry a valid student ID from their institution.
- Students from any college/university, branch, course, or year may participate.
- Participants may compete individually or in teams of up to 4 members.
- A participant may register for only one competition because the Ideathon and Buildathon will take place simultaneously.
- Participants must be physically present at the event to participate.

2. Common Competition Rules

- Each team must designate one Team Leader / Primary Participant.
- A participant cannot be a member of multiple teams.
- Maximum team size is 4 participants, including the Team Leader.
- Team composition cannot be changed after the respective competition begins unless explicitly permitted by the organizers.
- Participants must provide accurate information during registration.
- Plagiarism, impersonation, deliberate misrepresentation, or submission of work that participants do not have the right to use may result in disqualification.
- Open-source libraries, frameworks, APIs, AWS services, and other third-party resources may be used where permitted by their respective licenses and terms.
- Participants are responsible for complying with the terms and licenses of third-party tools and services they use.

3. Ideathon

Objective

The Ideathon is designed to evaluate participants' ability to identify a meaningful problem, develop a strong solution concept, explain its importance, and demonstrate that the idea is realistically feasible.

Problem Statement

Participants choose their own problem statement. The selected problem should address a genuine or meaningful need and have a clearly identifiable target user or beneficiary.

Project Preparation

The project/idea must be prepared before the event. Participants are expected to have their core idea and supporting material ready before the competition begins. This may include a prototype, mockups, wireframes, architecture diagrams, presentation material, research, or other relevant preparation.

The on-site preparation period is **not** intended for developing the core idea or project from scratch.

On-site Preparation Time

Participants will receive a limited preparation/setup period before pitching and judging begin. This time may be used to set up the presentation, open or connect a prototype/demo, make final presentation adjustments, and prepare the required material for the pitch.

Pitch Requirements

- **Problem:** What problem are you solving?
- **Importance:** Why does the problem matter?
- **Solution:** What are you proposing?
- **Working/Approach:** How would the solution work?
- **Feasibility:** How can it realistically be built and implemented?
- **Impact:** Who benefits and what potential impact could it create?
- **AWS integration:** If applicable, how does AWS contribute to the solution?

AWS Usage

AWS integration is encouraged but not mandatory. Participants are encouraged to use AWS services where they meaningfully contribute to the proposed solution, particularly services available through the AWS Free Tier.

Prototype / Supporting Material

A working prototype is not mandatory unless separately announced by the organizers. Participants may use supporting visuals, mockups, architecture diagrams, prototypes, or other material to strengthen their pitch.

4. Buildathon

Objective

The Buildathon challenges participants to turn a problem statement into a functional MVP or prototype using AI-assisted development within a strict time limit.

Problem Statement

The problem statement will be provided by the organizers at the beginning of the Buildathon. Participants will **not** choose their own problem statement for this competition.

Build Time

The official build time is **60 minutes**. If the organizers provide an additional extension period, the exact terms and deadline will be announced at the event. No work will be accepted after the final deadline communicated by the organizers.

Prepare Your Tools Beforehand

Participants are strongly advised to install, configure, log in to, and test all necessary tools before the Buildathon begins.

- AI development tools such as Kiro, Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Antigravity, or other tools.
- VS Code or another preferred IDE/editor.
- Git and any required development environments.
- Programming languages, runtimes, packages, and dependencies.
- AWS CLI or other AWS tooling, if required.
- Required browser extensions, accounts, API keys, and authentication.

Build time should be spent building and testing the solution — **not** downloading or configuring basic software.

AI-Assisted Development

AI-assisted development is permitted and encouraged. Participants may use Kiro, Claude Code, Cursor, Codex, Antigravity, GitHub Copilot, and other AI development tools. **Kiro is particularly encouraged.**

Participants are responsible for reviewing, testing, understanding, and being able to demonstrate the solution they submit.

Pre-Built Code & Preparation

Participants may prepare their development environment, install software, create accounts, configure tools, and familiarize themselves with their preferred workflow before the event.

The core solution to the provided problem statement **must** be developed during the official Buildathon period. Participants may not arrive with a pre-built solution intended to solve the announced challenge.

Internet & External Resources

Internet access, publicly available documentation, libraries, APIs, and development resources are permitted during the Buildathon unless the organizers announce otherwise.

Participants may not receive direct assistance from other participants, judges, mentors, or organizers during the build period unless explicitly permitted by the organizers.

AWS Usage

AWS service integration is encouraged but not mandatory. Participants may use AWS services where they meaningfully contribute to their solution. Participants are responsible for complying with AWS service terms and any applicable account or billing requirements.

5. Submission & Demonstration

- Final submission requirements, including repository/demo links and any required documentation, will be announced by the organizers during the event.
- Participants must submit their work before the final deadline.
- The submitted project must correspond to the solution developed for the competition.
- Participants may be asked to demonstrate the working solution to the judges.

6. Disqualification

The following may result in disqualification:

- Plagiarism, impersonation, or deliberate misrepresentation of work.
- Submitting another person's work as your own.
- Using a pre-built solution for the Buildathon's announced problem statement.
- Violating the official time limit or continuing work after the final deadline.
- Receiving unauthorized assistance during the competition.
- Tampering with another participant's work, systems, or accounts.
- Harassment, disruptive behavior, or serious misconduct.
- Providing false registration information.
- Any other serious violation of the competition rules or organizer instructions.

7. Organizer Authority

The organizers reserve the right to clarify, modify, or supplement rules when necessary for fair and safe conduct of the event. Any material changes will be communicated to participants.

The organizers and judges reserve the right to disqualify participants or teams for serious rule violations. Decisions of the judges regarding competition outcomes will be final.

8. Important Participant Checklist

- ☐ Register for only one competition.
- ☐ Carry a valid student ID.
- ☐ If participating as a team, confirm your team has no more than 4 members.
- ☐ For the Ideathon, prepare your idea/project and supporting material before arriving.
- ☐ For the Buildathon, install and test all development and AI tools beforehand.
- ☐ Ensure your accounts, logins, dependencies, and development environment are ready.
- ☐ Read the event-day instructions and be present before the competition starts.